

AI Training and Strategy Pipeline -- 24 Target Companies

John and Shane, internal working list | 3 July 2026 | Confidential

The playbook, proven at United Hardware: executive AI training first, then the six-document strategy proposal (competitor analysis, strategy on a page, EU AI Act exposure, grant intelligence). Sweet spot: federated networks (one centre, many independent members, none able to build AI alone) and strong Irish mid-market companies. Company details below are from desk knowledge and get verified before any approach.

Track 1 -- Warm paths (5)

Company	Industry	Why they fit / hook	Path
FDC Group	Accountancy, 40+ offices	Federated office network serving farmers and SMEs; train the firm, then member-office rollout	John is a client
Glennon Brothers	Timber / manufacturing	Family-owned, multi-site IRL and UK; forecasting, production and quality AI	Mike Glennon (demo shortlist)
Broadlake	Investment house	One relationship, a portfolio of Irish SMEs behind it; highest leverage door on the list	Pete Smyth (demo shortlist)
Original Irish Hotels	Hospitality federation	~60 independent hotels, shared central marketing; build once, arm members	Via Sean Lally
Brokers Ireland	Insurance federation	1,200+ independent brokers; regulation plus AI landing on them together	Via Campion Insurance

Track 2 -- Cold targets (19)

Company	Industry	Why they fit / hook
Gala Retail	Convenience retail	~270 independent stores, direct UHL analogue in grocery convenience
BWG Foods	Retail wholesale	Spar / Mace / XL network, ~1,000 stores from central distribution; forecasting and member tooling
Barry Group	Wholesale distribution	Costcutter and Carry Out network from Mallow; mid-size alternative to BWG
Musgrave	Retail wholesale	SuperValu / Centra; the scale play if ambition allows
totalhealth Pharmacy	Pharmacy buying group	70+ independent pharmacies; regulated, data-rich, members cannot build alone
Uniphar	Pharma services	Irish plc; supply chain and pharmacy services, heavy data estate
Centric Health	Healthcare	GP practice network; admin automation plus AI Act and GDPR exposure
ifac	Agri accountancy co-op	Farmer-owned, 30+ offices; clients already asking about AI
Dairygold	Dairy co-operative	Thousands of member suppliers; classic build-once-arm-members
Metamo / ILCU	Credit unions	Federated credit unions; EU AI Act credit-scoring exposure is exactly our strongest paper
Fexco	Fintech / fin services	Kerry HQ, 2,000+ staff; wants an Irish AI governance partner
Lawlink	Legal network	Independent solicitor firms; Article 4 AI literacy duty applies now, CPD-shaped training sale
XLVets Ireland	Veterinary network	Independent practices; member tooling and diagnostics AI
Joe Duffy Group	Motor retail	20+ dealerships; service scheduling, parts forecasting, used-car pricing
Combilift	Manufacturing	Monaghan forklift maker, exports to 85+ countries; flagship manufacturing name
McHale Engineering	Agri machinery	Mayo manufacturer, global exports; production and dealer-network AI

Company	Industry	Why they fit / hook
Kirby Group	Engineering services	Limerick M&E; contractor, 1,500+ staff; project intelligence and document AI
Keelings	Fresh produce	Grower, distributor and retailer-facing; forecasting and quality AI
iNua Collection	Hospitality	Irish regional four-star group; central office, independent properties

Deliberately excluded: Topline (direct United Hardware competitor; conflict with John's UHL board seat). Sequencing: the warm track overlaps the Personalized Intelligence demo shortlist; demo opens the relationship, training is the first paid engagement, the strategy proposal is the expansion. Suggested first three: FDC, Glennon Brothers, Broadlake (all warm, three industries, proves the model transfers beyond hardware).

Internal working document, John Webb O'Rourke and Shane McCarthy only. Company details REPORTED from desk knowledge, 3 July 2026; verify before approach.